

Radical Acceptance

Greater Nashua Mental Health Center

Instructions: Radical Acceptance is a DBT distress-tolerance skill: fully accepting reality as it is, without approving of it, to stop the added suffering that comes from fighting what cannot be changed. Acceptance is a practice you choose again and again.

The reality I am struggling to accept:

Acceptance vs. fighting reality

Pain + non-acceptance = suffering. We cannot change the past or facts outside our control; refusing to accept them keeps us stuck. Acceptance frees energy to respond skillfully.

What part of this is outside my control?

How have I been fighting reality (e.g., 'this shouldn't be', bitterness, avoidance)?

What would change if I accepted the facts of this situation?

Turning the mind & willingness

Acceptance is a choice you renew. Notice when you've turned away from it and gently turn back. Practice a coping or 'half-smile / willing hands' posture as you read your acceptance statement.

My acceptance statement (e.g., 'I can accept that... even though it is painful'):